MICROSOFT 365 OUTLOOK

Manage Your Inbox with Search Folders

Declutter and Stay Organized

Tame your inbox

While **61% of surveyed employees say they prefer email** over other communication tools, **70% also say that managing their inbox is one of their biggest productivity drains**.

Poor email management means that many people waste time looking for messages and “can’t find specific documents” in their inboxes.

The solution? Use search folders to organize incoming messages based on specific criteria, so you can manage your inbox *and* find messages much faster.

“The Email and Document Management Usage Benchmark Report,” Mail Manager, MailManager.com, January 2021.

Organize with search folders

Search folders don’t actually store messages; they simply group those that meet set criteria and show them to you all in one spot, like custom views. This helps you more efficiently find important messages and manage incoming mail.

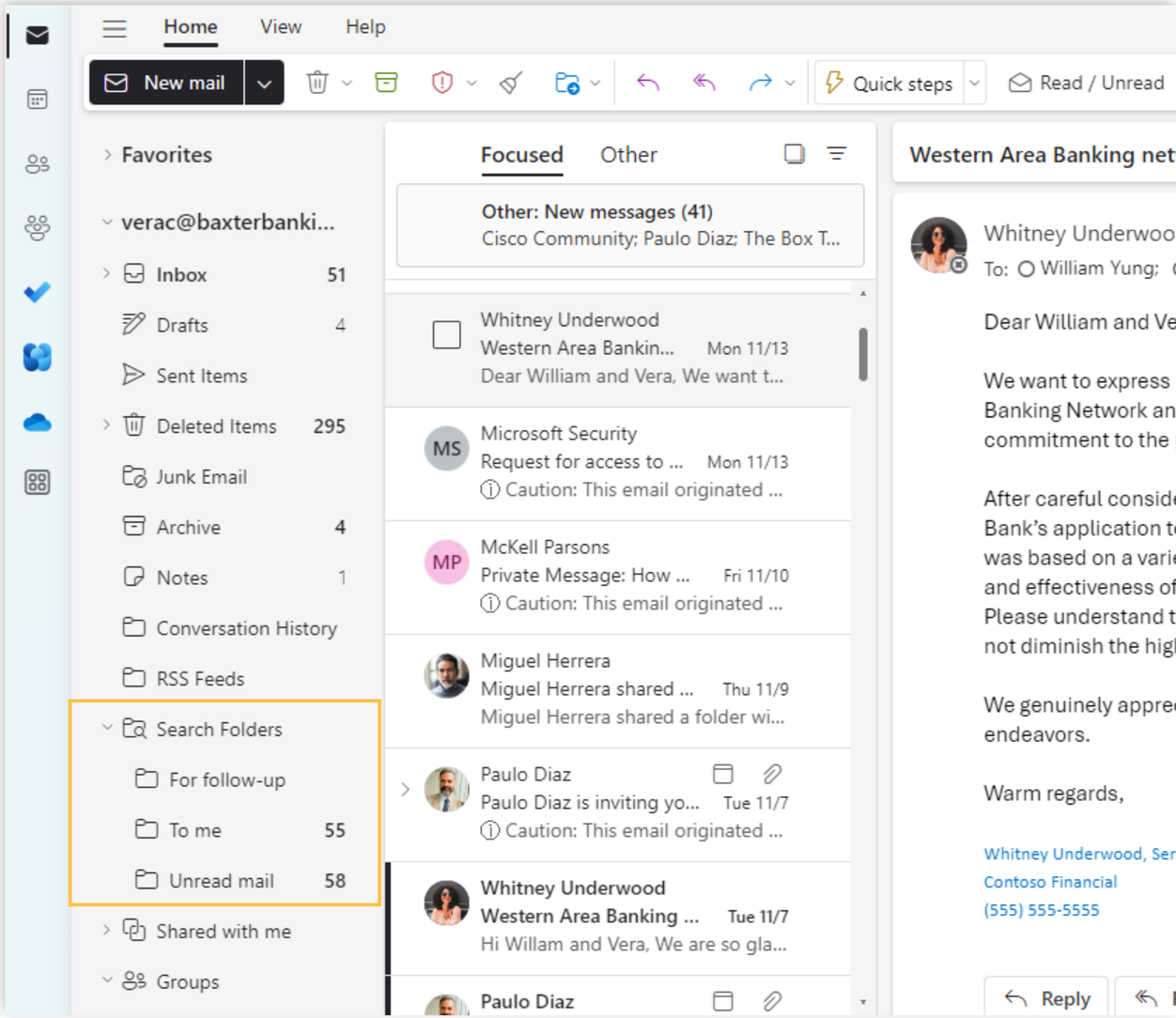
For example, create search folders for unread messages, mail sent directly to you (to separate it from group messages), messages from your boss or direct reports, or messages with a key word in the subject or body—whatever will help you quickly reach what’s important to you.

Use folders wisely

Keep it simple: Create only as many search folders as you'll realistically use. The goal is to simply your workflow, not complicate it.

Review regularly: Evaluate the efficiency of your folders each month. Are they keeping you organized? Should you add or eliminate anything?

Never fear: Remember, a single message can appear in multiple search folders. And when you need to clean up, don't worry—deleting a search folder doesn't delete any messages.



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